Technical Reports and Business Writing
Lab Guideline Handout

Technical Writing Course

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Department: CSE

Course / Section: CSE 3200 – 6B, 6C, 6D, 6E

Lab deliverables

- A short technical report
- A complaint business letter
- An inquiry email draft for Gmail
- A memo or internal notice
- An edited paragraph in formal technical style

Lab rule

Students should set the page format before writing and proofread every document before submission.

1. Page setup for MS Word / Google Docs

Element	Recommended setting
Page size	A4
Margins	1 inch / 2.54 cm on all sides
Body font	Times New Roman 12 or Arial 11
Line spacing	1.15 or 1.5 for academic work; single or 1.15 for business letter
Alignment	Left align for letters and emails; justified optional for reports
Paragraph spacing	6 pt after paragraphs or one blank line between sections

Heading hierarchy

Text level	Recommended size
Report title	16–18 pt bold
Main heading	14 pt bold
Sub-heading	12–13 pt bold
Body text	12 pt regular
Caption / source	10–11 pt

2. Technical report outline

Section	Purpose
Title page	Shows title, student details, course, teacher name and date
Abstract / Executive Summary	Summarizes purpose, method, finding and recommendation
Introduction	Gives background, problem, purpose and scope
Methodology	Explains how data or information were collected
Findings / Results	Presents facts, observations, data or tables
Discussion / Analysis	Explains the meaning of the findings
Conclusion	Summarizes the main answer
Recommendations	Suggests practical action
References / Appendices	Lists sources and supporting materials

Technical report mini-task

Topic: Problems and Solutions of Slow Internet Connection in a Computer Lab

Required sections: Title, Introduction, Findings, Conclusion and Recommendations.

3. Technical report sample paragraphs

Introduction

The computer lab requires a stable internet connection for practical classes, online research and software updates. However, students frequently experience slow browsing and interrupted downloads during lab hours. This report identifies the possible causes of the problem and recommends practical solutions to improve the network performance.

Methodology

Data were collected through student feedback, observation of lab sessions and a basic speed test conducted during peak class hours.

Findings

The internet speed decreased when more than 25 devices were connected. Some computers also showed high background data usage during software updates.

Conclusion

The slow internet connection affects practical classes and reduces students' ability to complete online tasks. The problem is mainly related to limited bandwidth, heavy device load and weak network control.

Recommendations

It is recommended that the lab authority increase bandwidth, check the router and cables regularly, restrict unnecessary downloads during class time and schedule software updates outside lab hours.

4. Business letter format

Order	Part	Example
1	Date	18 June 2026 OR June 18, 2026
2	Receiver address	The Sales Manager, Metro Furnishings, Dhaka
3	Salutation	Dear Sir / Dear Ms Huda / Dear Mr Khan
4	Subject line	Subject: Complaint about damaged office chairs
5	Opening paragraph	State why you are writing
6	Body paragraph	Explain facts, dates, item, quantity and problem
7	Closing paragraph	Request action politely
8	Complimentary close	Yours faithfully / Yours sincerely / Regards
9	Signature block	Signature + typed name + position/ID

5. Business letter technical terms and rules

- Letterhead: the organization name, address, phone, email or logo at the top of a formal letter.
- Full block letter: all parts of the letter begin at the left margin.
- Block letter: main parts are left-aligned, while the date and lower parts may be placed on the right.
- Semi-block letter: paragraphs are indented, and the date/lower parts are often placed center-right.

Salutation and closing match

Salutation	Correct closing
Dear Sir / Dear Madam	Yours faithfully
Dear Sir or Madam	Yours faithfully
Dear Mr Khan	Yours sincerely
Dear Ms Huda	Yours sincerely
Dear Dr Talukdar	Yours sincerely

Complaint letter structure

- Identify the purchase or order with date and reference number.
- Explain the problem clearly: wrong goods, damaged goods or faulty product.
- Mention evidence: model number, quantity, invoice or order number.
- Request a specific action: replacement, repair, refund or correction.
- Close politely and request a timely response.

6. Complaint letter sample

18 June 2026

The Sales Manager
Metro Furnishings
Dhaka

Subject: Complaint about damaged office chairs

Dear Sir,

On 12 June 2026, I purchased 10 office chairs from your store under order number MF-214. After delivery, three chairs were found damaged and two chairs were supplied in the wrong colour.

I request you to replace the damaged and incorrect chairs within seven working days. Copies of the invoice and delivery receipt are attached for your reference.

Yours faithfully,

[Signature]
[Student Name]

7. Business email in Gmail

Gmail field	What to write
To	Correct recipient email address
Cc	Visible copy recipient
Bcc	Hidden copy recipient
Subject	Clear purpose of the email
Body	Greeting, purpose, details, request and closing
Attachment	File, if required

Email etiquette

- Use a clear subject line, not vague words such as “One request”.
- Lead the reader to the message in the first sentence.
- Use short paragraphs and professional language.
- Show appropriate courtesy, but avoid emotional or careless tone.
- Check spelling, punctuation, recipient address and attachment reference before sending.
- A handwritten signature is not required in email; use a typed signature block.

Inquiry email format

- Subject line
- Greeting
- Reason for writing
- Specific information requested
- Expected response or deadline
- Closing and typed signature

8. Inquiry email sample

To: Metro Furnishings <sales@metrofurnishings.com>
Subject: Request for Office Furniture Catalogue

Dear Sir,

We are expanding our office and require additional desks, chairs and filing cabinets. Could you please send us your latest catalogue with prices, sizes, colours and delivery options for these items?

We would appreciate receiving the information by 23 June 2026, if possible.

Best regards,
Walid Mokles
Purchase Manager
Intercity Bank

9. Reply to inquiry email sample

To: Walid Mokles <walidm@intercitybank.com>
Subject: Re: Request for Office Furniture Catalogue

Dear Mr Mokles,

Thank you for your inquiry about office furniture. We have attached our latest catalogue, including prices, available sizes, colours and delivery options for desks, chairs and filing cabinets.

Most items are available for delivery within five working days after order confirmation. Please let us know if you would like a formal quotation.

Best regards,
Sales Department
Metro Furnishings

10. Memo format and sample

Label	Example
To	All Students
From	Course Teacher
Date	18 June 2026
Subject	Submission of Technical Report
Message	Short official information

Sample memo:

To: All Students
From: Course Teacher
Date: 18 June 2026
Subject: Submission of Technical Report

All students are requested to submit their technical reports by 25 June 2026. The report should include a title page, introduction, findings, conclusion and recommendations.

11. Editing practice

Original informal version

The internet in our lab is very bad. It does not work properly and students always face many problems. I think someone should fix it quickly.

Improved professional version

The internet connection in the computer lab is unstable and frequently affects students' practical work. The possible causes include limited bandwidth, router malfunction and poor network configuration. Therefore, the network system should be checked and maintained.

12. Peer review checklist

- Correct document type and format
- A4 page size and correct margin
- Readable font and consistent spacing
- Clear purpose in opening paragraph
- Specific details such as date, item, quantity and order number
- Formal and courteous tone
- No grammar, spelling or punctuation errors
- Correct closing and signature block

13. Assessment rubric: 20 marks

Criteria	Marks	What to check
Correct format	4	A4, margin, font, headings and document structure
Content completeness	4	All required parts are present
Clarity and organization	4	Logical flow and clear purpose
Professional tone	3	Formal, polite and reader-focused
Grammar and mechanics	3	Spelling, punctuation and sentence control
Submission quality	2	Clean file name, complete portfolio, on time